

Canyoning near Zermatt/Tasch - May vs June

Self-sufficient planning sheet focused on dam, hydro and condition information - not booking or guide contacts

Prepared for experienced canyoneers. This is not a topo and not a go/no-go decision. It does not replace a current canyon topo, anchor report, weather/hydrology check, visual flow check, emergency plan, rope plan or local legal access check. The emphasis is on which routes are realistic in May versus June and which numbers/sites are relevant for dam or condition information.

Zermatt -> Tasch train is 12 min; total times below add estimated driving from Tasch and exclude parking, walking to entry, shuttles and traffic. Source: Zermatt official travel page and train timetable data. [S1] [S2]

Critical dam / condition contacts

Use case	Information to check	Number / site	Scope / caveat	Sources
Boggera / Cresciano / Osogna-Nala	OFIBLE canyoning infoline; mandatory before entering. Official page also says canyoning is forbidden 22:00-08:00.	+41 91 756 66 15	Hydroelectric installations in OFIMA/OFIBLE basins. Call-in does not replace visual flow check or topo-specific water markers.	[S14] [S15] [S16]
OFIBLE backup contacts	General office / emergency control centre if infoline or instructions are unclear.	General: +41 91 756 66 66 Emergency command centre: +41 91 756 66 11	Directory/contact listing, not a substitute for the canyoning infoline.	[S23]
Massaschlucht	Dam/glacier risk recordings.	German: +41 27 921 65 25 French: +41 27 970 59 04	Descente-Canyon says to call Blatten tourism if the recording is not up to date. Huge dam/glacier-fed catchment.	[S6]
Gondo / Zwischbergen	EES canyoning information site for releases, maintenance and tests; topo says to consult it before entry.	https://ees-canyoning.ch Directory fallback: Kraftwerk Gondo +41 27 979 12 51; EES Sion +41 27 345 29 40	Website is the primary source noted by the topo. Directory numbers are not confirmed as canyon hotlines; use only to ask for the correct current hydro contact if the site is unavailable.	[S4] [S24] [S25]
Non-dam-flagged Valais / Ticino routes	No public dam hotline found in the checked sources. Use recent debit reports, visual flow checks at known checkpoints, MeteoSwiss rain/snowmelt context and local hydrological data.	No single official phone found	Absence of a listed dam hotline is not proof of absence of hydro risk. Verify with up-to-date topo and local current reports.	[S7] [S9] [S11] [S12]

Important interpretation

For OFIBLE canyons, the infoline is mandatory but is not enough by itself. The topographic water markers remain decisive: Cresciano/Boggera superieur requires the final lower waterfall to show only one jet on river-right and no river-left jets; Osogna lower requires no water in the left tube at the big slide below the chapel. For Massa, the dam/glacier recordings are route-specific risk information; if stale, the topo says to call Blatten tourism. For Gondo, the topo points to the EES canyoning site and explains that the small buffer retention can become problematic if inflow exceeds turbine capacity or if turbinage stops unexpectedly.

May - practical list

May is materially different from June: snowmelt and cold/high water make the nearby Valais options much less reliable. The strongest May plan, if overnight is acceptable, is usually Ticino with OFIBLE checks.

Rank	Option	Reason	Must check
1	Boggera lower/Plus or Val Cresciano if flow is correct	Most realistic adventurous May plan with official OFIBLE canyoning infoline.	OFIBLE +41 91 756 66 15; topo water markers.
2	Osogna/Nala lower or intermedio	Serious Ticino option; May-October appears in OpenCanyon, but dam/automatic flushing risk must be respected.	OFIBLE +41 91 756 66 15; lower slide marker.
3	Malvaglia	Best early-season fallback when bigger canyons have too much water.	No public dam hotline found; verify local flow visually.
4	Feschelbach or Morge	Closer Valais options if you insist on staying near Zermatt, but May remains conditional.	No public dam hotline found; current debit reports + visual check.

Option	Area	May suitability	Time from Zermatt	Dam / condition info to call or check	Commitment	Src
Gondo / Zwischbergen	Valais / Simplon	Poor to marginal in May; only consider late May after stable cold/dry weather and explicit EES/site confirmation. Snowmelt + hydro risk are the issue.	~1h30-1h45	Check ees-canyoning.ch first. If unavailable, call EES directory contacts only to ask for current canyoning/release info: Kraftwerk Gondo +41 27 979 12 51; EES Sion +41 27 345 29 40. Also inspect the retention basin / inflow as topo describes.	High: v4a3IV, 50 m rope, ~4 h descent, few escapes, hydro installation risk.	S3 S4 S24 S25
Massaschlucht / Massa	Valais / Blatten-Naters	Poor in May unless exceptional low-risk conditions. Glacier/dam-fed; snowmelt risk is central.	~1h05-1h20	Call risk recordings: DE +41 27 921 65 25; FR +41 27 970 59 04. If recording is stale, contact Blatten tourism as topo says.	High to very high if full descent: v4a3IV, full topo descent ~10 h, few escapes, huge dam/glacier catchment.	S5 S6
Feschelbach	Valais / Leuk	Late May possible only after low-flow verification; better in June. No dam hotline found.	~1h00-1h10	No public dam number found. Use latest Descente-Canyon debit observations and inspect the last waterfall from the lower access as the topo notes.	High: v4a2IV on Descente-Canyon; commercial route listed difficulty 4/5, long/vertical and for experienced canyioners.	S7 S8
Morge	Valais / Conthey-Saviese	Possible in May if flow is low; less close and less exceptional for experienced canyioners.	~1h25-1h40	No public dam number found. Check recent debit observations and visual flow at access/exit; avoid after rain or warm snowmelt pulses.	Medium-high: v3a3IV on Descente-Canyon; 3 h descent, 20 m rope.	S9 S10
Gorge de Daillon	Valais / Conthey	Possible late May; technical half-day option, not the most adventurous.	~1h25-1h40	No public dam number found. Visual flow check and recent condition reports only.	Medium: listed 3/5, steep and wild, abseils up to 20 m, ~3 h in canyon.	S11
Raspille	Valais / Miege-Sierre	Usually the easiest May fallback, but low adventure value for experienced people.	~1h15-1h30	No public dam number found. Check recent condition reports and visual flow.	Low to medium: commercial difficulty 1/5; Descente-Canyon route is v4a4III but commonly run as introductory canyon.	S12 S13
Boggera lower / Boggera Plus	Ticino / Cresciano	Good May option; one of the best realistic May targets if overnight is OK.	~3h15-3h45	Mandatory OFIBLE infoline +41 91 756 66 15. Official OFIBLE page: canyoning forbidden 22:00-08:00. Call before entry; follow all instructions.	Medium to medium-high depending section; lower/plus is more manageable than the superieur/integrale.	S14 S15 S16
Val Cresciano superieur / Boggera integrale	Ticino / Cresciano	Late May possible but treat as summer canyon; do not force it in high water.	~3h15-3h45	Mandatory OFIBLE +41 91 756 66 15. Topo water check: at the final waterfall of the lower section there should be one jet on the right and no jets river-left (RG).	High: v4a4IV, 5-7 h descent, strong commitment, few escapes, upstream dam.	S14 S15
Osogna / Nala lower or intermedio	Ticino / Osogna	Good May target but serious; select section by flow. Lower may be more realistic than intermedio early season.	~3h15-3h45	Mandatory OFIBLE +41 91 756 66 15. Lower topo check: at the big slide visible on approach below the chapel, there must be no water in the left tube.	High: intermedio v4a3IV / OpenCanyon v4a4IV; lower flagged dam/automatic flushing in OpenCanyon.	S14 S16 S17 S18
Malvaglia	Ticino / Malvaglia	Strong May fallback; sources describe it as a sure bet early season when other canyons have too much water.	~3h00-3h30	No public dam hotline found in checked route sources. Still verify rainfall/flow locally and visually.	Medium-high: jumps up to 10 m, abseils up to 80 m in Ticino Adventures description, ~3-4 h in canyon.	S19
Pontirone / Pontirone integrale	Ticino / Biasca-Pontirone	Generally not a May primary objective; most published seasons start 1 June. Late May only with strong current beta.	~3h15-3h45	No public dam hotline found in checked sources. Use current topo/debit reports and visual flow; avoid high flow.	High: 1h15 approach, technical canyon, 42 m airy abseil; integrale adds 50 m abseils and strenuous approach.	S20
Iragna / Iragna integrale	Ticino / Iragna	Marginal in May; better from June. May only with current low-water beta.	~3h15-3h45	No public dam hotline found in checked sources. Use current flow reports and local visual checks.	Medium-high to high: standard Level 3, jumps up to 13 m and 40 m abseil; integrale long and technical.	S21
Lodrino	Ticino / Lodrino	No for May. Natural-flow large drainage; short season normally starts July.	~3h15-3h45	No public dam hotline found in checked sources. The condition issue is natural flow from a large drainage area; use current expert beta only.	Very high: Level 4 difficult to very difficult; experienced rappellers only.	S22

June - practical list

June opens up better close-to-Zermatt options, especially Gondo, Feschelbach and Massa. Ticino remains the higher-quality canyoning area if an overnight is acceptable.

Rank	Option	Reason	Must check
1	Gondo / Zwischbergen	Best close adventurous canyon when hydro/flow are acceptable.	ees-canyoning.ch; EES contacts only if site/instructions unclear.
2	Feschelbach	Closest strong technical/vertical day without known dam hotline.	Recent debit reports; visual lower-flow check.
3	Massaschlucht	Big alpine canyon close to Zermatt, but glacier/dam risk makes it more serious than it looks.	DE/FR risk recordings; Blatten tourism if stale.

Rank	Option	Reason			Must check
4	Ticino: Cresciano/Nala/Pontirone/Iragna	Better canyon quality with overnight; June opens more serious Ticino options.			OFIBLE for Cresciano/Nala; current visual flow for others.

Option	Area	June suitability	Time from Zermatt	Dam / condition info to call or check	Commitment	Src
Gondo / Zwischbergen	Valais / Simplon	Viable June candidate but not automatic. Hydro and snowmelt remain critical; some tourism pages list July-Oct, while topo says summer.	~1h30-1h45	Check ees-canyoning.ch for releases/maintenance/tests. Fallback directory contacts only to ask for correct current hydro info: Kraftwerk Gondo +41 27 979 12 51; EES Sion +41 27 345 29 40.	High: v4a3IV, 50 m rope, ~4 h descent, few escapes, hydro risk. Best close adventurous option only when hydro/flow are clearly acceptable.	S3 S4 S24 S25
Massaschlucht / Massa	Valais / Blatten-Naters	Possible in June but still dam/glacier-controlled; avoid warm melt periods and stale recordings.	~1h05-1h20	Call DE +41 27 921 65 25 or FR +41 27 970 59 04. If not current, call Blatten tourism. Inspect dam/water level where topo indicates.	High to very high: full topo is v4a3IV, ~10 h descent, few escapes; commercial variants may shorten/bypass sections.	S5 S6
Feschelbach	Valais / Leuk	Good June candidate after stable weather and low flow.	~1h00-1h10	No public dam number found. Use latest debit reports and lower-cascade visual inspection.	High: v4a2IV on Descente-Canyon; long/vertical route, commercial source lists 4/5 and experience required.	S7 S8
Morge	Valais / Conthey-Saviese	Good June fallback; less committing than Gondo/Massa/Feschelbach.	~1h25-1h40	No public dam number found. Check recent debit reports, rain history and visual flow.	Medium-high: v3a3IV; 3 h descent; 20 m rope.	S9 S10
Gorge de Daillon	Valais / Conthey	Good June half-day option.	~1h25-1h40	No public dam number found. Visual flow check + recent condition reports.	Medium: 3/5, technical and vertical, abseils up to 20 m.	S11
Raspille	Valais / Miege-Sierre	Good June fallback; easy/introductory in most commercial descriptions.	~1h15-1h30	No public dam number found. Check condition reports and visual flow.	Low to medium: useful if other routes are too high, but not a top experienced objective.	S12 S13
Boggera lower / Boggera Plus	Ticino / Cresciano	Good June option; reliable relative to bigger Ticino canyons.	~3h15-3h45	Mandatory OFIBLE +41 91 756 66 15. Official OFIBLE page: canyoning forbidden 22:00-08:00.	Medium to medium-high; stronger option than Valais fallbacks if overnight is OK.	S14 S15 S16
Val Cresciano superieur / Boggera integrale	Ticino / Cresciano	Good June objective if OFIBLE/flow checks are clean.	~3h15-3h45	Mandatory OFIBLE +41 91 756 66 15. Flow marker: only one jet on right at final lower waterfall; no RG jets.	High: v4a4IV, 5-7 h descent, strong commitment and few escapes.	S14 S15
Osogna / Nala lower or intermedio	Ticino / Osogna	Good June objective; choose section based on flow and group speed.	~3h15-3h45	Mandatory OFIBLE +41 91 756 66 15. Lower topo slide marker: no water in the left tube below the chapel.	High: intermedio v4a3IV / OpenCanyon v4a4IV; lower v5a4III on OpenCanyon with dam/automatic flushing flags.	S14 S16 S17 S18
Malvaglia	Ticino / Malvaglia	Good June fallback if other canyons are high; also valid as standalone day.	~3h00-3h30	No public dam hotline found in checked route sources. Verify rainfall and visual flow.	Medium-high: experienced-canyoner test piece in places; 80 m abseil noted by Ticino Adventures.	S19
Pontirone / Pontirone integrale	Ticino / Biasca-Pontirone	Good June objective; SwissChallenge lists 1 June to beginning of October.	~3h15-3h45	No public dam hotline found in checked sources. Use current debit/topo beta and visual flow.	High: technical, deep, 42 m airy abseil; integrale is strenuous with 50 m abseils.	S20
Iragna / Iragna integrale	Ticino / Iragna	Good June objective; SwissChallenge lists 1 June to beginning of October.	~3h15-3h45	No public dam hotline found in checked sources. Check current conditions and visual flow.	Medium-high to high: Level 3, 13 m optional jumps, 40 m abseil; integrale is long/technical.	S21
Lodrino	Ticino / Lodrino	Usually no for early June; maybe late June only with unusually low flow. Standard listed season starts 1 July.	~3h15-3h45	No public dam hotline found in checked sources. Natural-flow large drainage; rely on current expert beta and visual flow only.	Very high: Level 4 difficult to very difficult; short season; active rappelling mastery required.	S22

Source notes

Sources were checked on 2026-05-02. Some route pages and commercial pages are maintained independently and may disagree. For self-guided decisions, treat official hydro pages/infolines and same-week field reports as higher priority than generic season text.

Key	Source	URL
S1	Zermatt official travel / shuttle	https://zermatt.swiss/en/plan-book/arrival
S2	Trainline Zermatt-Tasch timing	https://www.thetrainline.com/en-us/train-times/zermatt-to-tasch
S3	Descente-Canyon Gondo summary	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon/2750/Gondo.html
S4	Descente-Canyon Gondo hydro description	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon-description/2750/topo.html
S5	Descente-Canyon Massa summary	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon/21007/Massaschlucht.html
S6	Descente-Canyon Massa description / risk recordings	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon-description/21007/topo.html
S7	Descente-Canyon Feschelbach	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon/21972/Feschelbach.html
S8	Canyoning Access Feschelbach	https://canyoning-access.ch/en/feschelbach-canyon/
S9	Descente-Canyon Morge	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon/23209/Morge.html
S10	Canyoning Access Morge	https://canyoning-access.ch/en/canyon-morge-2/
S11	Canyoning Access Daillon	https://canyoning-access.ch/en/daillon-canyon-gorge/
S12	Descente-Canyon Raspille	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon/21006/Raspille.html
S13	Canyoning Access Raspille	https://canyoning-access.ch/en/canyon-raspille-2/
S14	OFIBLE official Info Canyoning	https://www.ofible.ch/info-canyoning/
S15	Descente-Canyon Cresciano superieur	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon-description/2663/topo.html
S16	Descente-Canyon Osogna inferieur	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon-description/2676/topo.html
S17	Descente-Canyon Osogna intermediaire	https://www.descente-canyon.com/canyoning/canyon/22494/Osogna-intermediaire.html
S18	OpenCanyon Nala intermedio	https://www.opencanyon.org/en/canyon/51c506d1-ba29-443a-be5a-7b6842dac325
S19	Ticino Adventures Malvaglia	https://ticinoadventures.com/product/canyoning-malvaglia/
S20	SwissChallenge Pontirone	https://www.swisschallenge.ch/en/canyoning/canyoning-level-3/canyoning-pontirone-expedition.html
S21	SwissChallenge Iragna	https://www.swisschallenge.ch/en/canyoning/canyoning-level-3/iragna.html
S22	SwissChallenge Lodrino	https://www.swisschallenge.ch/en/canyoning/canyoning-level-4/lodrino.html
S23	OFIBLE contact listing	https://www.local.ch/it/d/locarno/6600/centrale-elettrica/ofible-officine-idroelettriche-di-blenio-sa-3VSqSHmRs5b4ZSIBlkCBOA
S24	EES Gondo plant directory listing	https://www.allbiz.ch/energie-electr-du-simplon-sa-kraftwerk-027-979-12-51
S25	EES Sion directory listing	https://www.local.ch/en/d/sion/1950/energy/energie-electrique-du-simplon-sa-ees-a4MxCM0TVIb-heVdpK3T6Q

Commitment shorthand

Low: short/easy commercial style route or non-canyoning gorge adventure. Medium: technical obstacles but limited duration/escapes. High: v4/a3+ or strong duration/verticality, few escapes, hydro/glacier risk or serious aquatic conditions. Very high: short season, strong natural flow, active rappelling mastery required, or major consequences from flow change.